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FOUNDATION TO SOCIOLOGY

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Foundations of Sociology

1: What is Sociology? & Its Emergence

Foundation to Sociology:
What is Sociology? Where did Sociology as a discipline emerge?

Sociology is the study of society, social relationships, and how people live together in groups. It helps us understand human behavior, culture, and institutions like family, religion, and education.

Sociology began in Europe during the 19th century after the French and Industrial Revolutions.

Auguste Comte coined the term "Sociology" in 1338. Ine book "Positive Phiosophy", in book, introduc science of society" or "Social Physics". ˡ Adolűf Quettlett used it
Sociology means the edy edy or siency of society and social behavior.

2: Difference between Sociology and common sense

Sociology	Common Sense
Systematic Study: Based on evidence and testing.	Anecdotal: Based on individual experiences and casual observations.
Objective: Minimizes personal bias and value judgments.	Subjective: Heavily influenced by personal feelings, beliefs, and values.
Scientific Method: Uses rigorous research techniques (surveys, interviews).	Intuition: Relies on gut feelings, tradition, and shared assumptions.
Critical Thinking: Questions 'taken-for-granted' social phenomena.	Acceptance: Tends to accept societal 'norms' without deep questioning.

Organic Analogy & Evolution

A Society as Organism	Integration	Differentiation	Spencer's Evolution
An entity, total system, a super-organic entity	Growth and complexity	Interdependent structures and functions	Developmental stages: simple to complex

Sociology is the scientific study of how human groups originate, organize, and relate to each other in society.

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THE SCOPE & PERSPECTIVES OF SOCIOLOGY

IBN KHALDUN: THE FORERUNNER

Asabiyyah: Social Solidarity and Group Consciousness

The Muqaddimah: Analyzing the rise and fall of civilizations

Cyclical Theory: Sedentary vs. Nomadic life ↳ 1377 CE

THE SCOPE OF SOCIOLOGY: TWO SCHOOLS OF THOUGHT

Formalistic School (Simmel)	Synthetic School (Durkheim/Hobhouse)
Focus: Forms of Social Relationship	Focus: General social life as a whole.
Léopold von Wiese, Alfred Vierkandt	Morris Ginsberg
Specific and pure science	General and all-inclusive
	eg Pitirim Sorokin
Key Figure: George Simmel	Key Figure: Emile Durkheim

THEORETICAL PERSPECTIVES

- **Structural Functionalism:** Society as a system of stable, interdependent. **Key Thinkers:** Émile Durkheim, Talcott Parsons, Robert K. Merton.
- **Conflict Theory:** Society as an arena of inequality and power struggle. **Key Thinkers:** Karl Marx, Max Weber, Ralf Dahrendorf.
- **Symbolic Interactionism:** Micro-level focus on symbols and social meanings. **Key Thinkers:** George Herbert Mead, Herbert Blumer, Erving Goffman.
- **Structuralism:** Analyzing underlying social structures and rules. **Key Thinkers:** Claude Lévi-Strauss, Roland Barthes, Ferdinand de Saussure.
- **Post-Structuralism:** Challenging fixed structures and power truths. **Key Thinkers:** Michel Foucault, Jacques Derrida
- **Post-Modernism:** The rejection of grand narratives; focus on fragmentation and identity. **Key Thinkers:** Jean Baudrillard, Frederic Jameson, Ihab Hassan.

Asabiyyah: Social Solidarity and Group Consciousness
The Muqadimah: Analyzing the rise and fall of civilizations
Cyclical Theory: Sedentary vs. Nomadie life 1377 CE

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Sociological Perspectives

Perspective	Time Period	Key Thinkers
Structural Functionalism	Late 19th – Mid 20th C	Êmile Durkheim, Talcott Parsons, Robert K. Merton
Conflict Perspective	19th – 20th C	Karl Marx, Max Weber, Ralf Dahrendorf, Lewis Coser
Symbolic Interactionism	Early 20th C	George Herbert Mead, Charles H. Cooley, Erving Goffman
Structuralism	Mid 20th C	Ferdinand de Saussure, Claude Lêvi-Strauss, Roland Barthes
Post-Structuralism	1960s – 1970s	Michel Foucault, Jacques Derrida, Julia Kristeva
Postmodernism	Post–World War II	Jean-Francois Lyotard, Jean Baudrillard, Fredric Jameson
Postcolonialism	Mid–Late 20th C	Edward Said, Homi Bhabha, Gayatri Spivak, Frantz Fanon

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Waves of Feminism

Perspective	Time Period	Key Thinkers / Figures
First Wave Feminism	Late 19th Century – Early 20th Century (c. 1848–1920)	Mary Wollstonecraft
Second Wave Feminism	1960s – 1980s	Betty Friedan, Simone de Beauvoir, Kate Millett, Shulamith Firestone, bell hooks
Third Wave Feminism	1990s – 2000s	Kimberlé Crenshaw, Judith Butler, Rebecca Walker, Chandra Talpade Mohanty
Fourth Wave Feminism	2012 – Present	Tarana Burke, Emma Watson, Malala Yousafzai, Global feminist influencers and digital activists

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Schools of feminism

School of Feminism	Time Period	Key Figures
Liberal Feminism	Late 18th Century – Mid 20th Century (c. 1848–1920)	Mary Wollstonecraft, John Stuart Mill, Harriet Taylor Mill
Marxist Feminism	Mid 19th Century – Present	Friedrich Engels, Clara Zetkin, Alexandra Kollontai, Silvia Federici
Radical Feminism	1960s – 1980s	Shulamith Firestone, Andrea Dworkin, Catharine MacKinnon, Kate Millett
Socialist Feminism	1970s – Present	Juliet Mitchell, Angela Davis
Psychoanalytic Feminism	1970s – 1980s	Nancy Chodorow, Julia Kristeva, Luce Irigaray
Black Feminism	1970s – Present	bell hooks, Audre Lorde, Kimberlé Crenshaw, Patricia Hill Collins
Ecofeminism	1980s – Present	Vandana Shiva, Maria Mies, Carolyn Merchant
Standpoint Feminism	1980s – Present	Dorothy Smith, Sandra Harding, Nancy Hartsock
Cultural Feminism	1980s – Present	Carol Gilligan, Leela Dube, Uma Chakravarti, Mary Daly
Postmodern Feminism	1980s – Present	Judith Butler
Dalit Feminism	1990s – Present	Gopal Guru Sharmila Rege

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Differences Between Indian and Western Feminism

Indian Feminism	Western Feminism
• Focuses on issues specific to Indian women, including caste, dowry, child marriage, and local socio-economic condiions.	• Focuses on issues like gender, patriarchy, and reproductive rights, often within a broader global context.
• Deeply intersectional, addressing caste, religion, class and colonial history along with gender.	• Primarily focuses on gender and patriarchy, with race and class issues included to a lesser extent.
• Works towards social justice, equity, and addressing local cultural contexts and traditions.	• Primarily focuses on individual rights, gender equality, and dismantling patriarchy.
• Led by grassroots activists, often amplifying the voices of marginalized and lower-caste women.	• Historically shaped by middle-to-upper class, predominantly white women.
• Emphasizes collective action, commiinity-based solutions, and local traditions.	• Emphasizes individual rights, advocacy, and legal reforms.
Key Figures	**Key Figures**
Savitribai Phule Tarabai Shinde Kamla Bhasin Vandana Shiva	Simone de Beauvoir Betty Friedan Gloria Steinem bell hooks

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Founding Figures Series

Auguste Comte

Born: 19 January 1798, France

Died: 5 September 1857, France

Key Influences

- **St. Simon**
- **Rousseau**
- **Adam Smith**

Overview

- Considered the father of sociology
- Coined the word Sociology in the year 1838-39 (originally called it 'social physics')
- Played a pivotal role in establishing the field as a distinct scientific discipline
- Envisioned a 'sociocracy' for societal betterment

Major Theories

Positivism

The belief that knowledge should be derived from empirical, observable phenomena based on scientific methods.

Sociocracy & Social Reform

Sociology should contribute to societal betterment; envisioned an advisory role for social scientists.

Consensus Universalis

Fundamental principle for understanding social order; necessary interconnection and agreement among parts of society.

Law of Three Stages

Societies progress through three distinct stages of intellectual development:

Theological Stage

Human understanding based on supernatural/ religious explanations.

- Fetishism
- Polytheism
- Monotheism

Metaphysical Stage

Abstract philosophical thinking replaces theology; explain the world through abstract forces.

Scientific or Positive Stage

Empirical observation and scientific reasoning replace abstract philosophy and superstition.

Social Statics and Social Dynamics

Social Statics

Examines forces which hold society together, focusing on social order and stability (e.g., family, religion, language).

Social Dynamics

Focuses on the processes of social change and progress; societies evolve predictably towards more complexity.

Religion of Humanity

Later proposed a "Religion of Humanity" where traditional religions practices and institutions are replaced by a secular religion devoted to humanity itself.

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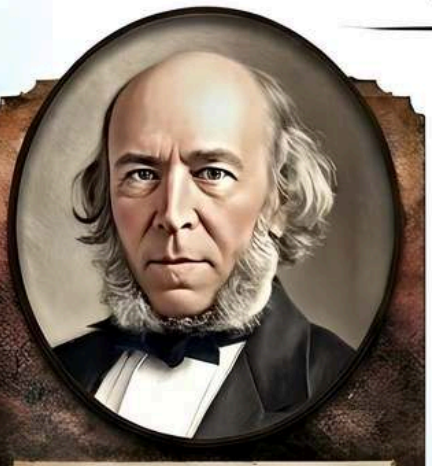
Founding Figures Series

Herbert Spencer



Born: 27 April 1820, United Kingdom [cite: 1]

Died: 8 December 1903, United Kingdom [cite: 1]

Key Influences

- Charles Darwin
- Thomas Malthus
- Auguste Comte
- Ayn Rand

Overview

- Considered the second father of Sociology
- One of the first to lay down principles of Structure Functionalism by introducing 'structure' and 'function'
- Strongly opposed state intervention, believing in laissez-faire principles and individualism

Major Theories

Social Darwinism	The Organism Metaphor	Spencer's Evolutionism
Applying evolution to societies	Society as a system of interdependent parts	Evolution as a change from the simple to the complex

Organic Analogy & Evolution

A Society as Organism	Integration	Differentiation	Spencer's Evolution
An entity, total system, a super-organic entity	Growth and complexity	Interdependent structures and functions	Developmental stages: simple to complex

Militant Societies	Industrial Societies
Coercion, centralized control, rigid hierarchy	Voluntary cooperation, individual freedom, contractual relations

Spencer's Social Classification

Based on size and complexity: societies evolve through simple, compound, doubly compound, and trebly compound stages (families, clans, tribes, nations)

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Founding Figures Series

Vilfredo Pareto

Born: 15 July 1848, Paris, France

Died: 19 August 1923, Switzerland

Key Influences

- Walras (León Walras)
- Machiavelli (Niccolò Machiavelli)
- Auguste Comte
- Adam Smith

Overview

- Developing the Logico-Experimental Method as a scientific approach to study society.
- Emphasized empirical observation and logical classification in a value-neutral, scientific way.
- Pareto saw society as an equilibrium system striving towards natural balance.

Logico-Experimental Method & Human Action

- The Logico-Experimental Method: Use facts and general laws; rejects moral judgments.
- Logical Actions: Both means and ends are rationally related (e.g., using a thermometer).
- Non-Logical Actions: Based on sentiments/norms; rituals, superstitions, voting, fashion. (These dominate social life).

Major Theories

- Pareto Principle (80/20 Rule): Small segment controls majority of resources.
- Elite Theory: Society always ruled by a minority ("the elite").
- Circulation of Elites: Old elites replaced by new ones to maintain power.
- Residues & Derivations: Distinction between underlying forces (residues) and justifications (derivations).

Residues (Underlying Forces)

Perpetual forces driving human behavior (e.g., instinct for combination, persistence of aggregates). Highlight the irrational base of human action.

Derivations (Justifications)

Social masks or logical rationalizations used to rationalize behavior. These are not true explanations.

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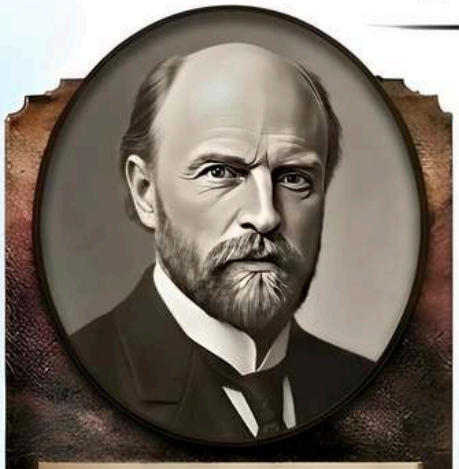
Founding Figures Series

Ferdinand Tönnies



Born: 26 July 1855, Oldenswort, Germany

Died: 9 April 1936, Kiel, Germany

Key Influences

- Thomas Hobbes
- Karl Marx
- Friedrich Paulsen
- Wilhelm Wundt

Overview

- A pioneering figure in German sociology.
- Coined and best known for the key distinction between Gemeinschaft (community) and Gesellschaft (society).
- Critically analyzed the shift from traditional to modern society.

Major Theories

Theory of Will	Gemeinschaft & Gesellschaft	Gesellschaft (Society)
Distinction between Natural Will (Wesenwille) Rational Will (*Kürwille*).	Natural Will (*Wesenwille*) and Rational Will (*Kürwille*).	Societal relations based on Rational, characterized by impersonal, indirect, and deliberate associations, like urban life.

Gemeinschaft (Community)	Gesellschaft (Society)
Social associations based on Natural Will; relationships are personal, direct, and tied to kinship or tradition.	Societal relations based on Rational Will; characterized, like those in modern urban life.

Theory of Will

Natural Will (Wesenwille) - drives actions preserving community bonds.
Rational Will (Kürwille) - guides to behaviors based on self-interest and rational calculation or tactielity.

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Founding Figures Series:
Thorstein Veblen

Born: 30 July 1857, United States

Died: 3 August 1929, United States

Key Influences

Derived from common Veblen knowledge, and the texts:

- Karl Marx
- Herbert Spencer
- William Graham Sumner
- Gustav von Sehmoller

(or others deemed relevant)

Overview

- A leading figure of the Progressive Era in American sociology and economics.
- Known for coining the concept of Conspicuous Consumption.
- Critically analyzed the leisure class and social stratification.

Major Theories

Conspicuous Consumption	Leisure Class Theory	Vicarious Consumption
Display of wealth to demonstrate social status.	Theory about non-productive economie activities of the wealthy.	Lower classes mimicking the consumption of the upper classes.
Consumption as a form of status competition.	Maintenance of status through soeial stratification	Personal cost for a service worker.

Key Concept Details

- **Conspicuous Leisure:** Visible abstention from productive work as a form of social display.
- **Conspicuous Waste:** Extravagant and non-utilitarian expenditure to prove pecuniary reputability.
- **Instinct of Workmanship:** Vehlen's concept of an innate drive towards efficient and purposeful activity, contrasting with waste.

Veblen's Theory in Detail

The Theory of the Leisure Class (1899) presents an in-depth analysis of social stratification. Veblen describes the "leisure class" as a powerful elite that avoids useful productive labor and maintains its soeial dominance through visible and extravagant spending, known as "Conspicuous Consumption." This class creates a predatory hierarchy where status is demonstrated through wastefulness. Key elements like "Conspicuous Leisure" and "Conspicuous Waste" are critical tools for validating social position. Conspieuous consumption acts as a universal status competition, driving inferior classes to mimic upper-class expenditure patterns, even at personal cost, reinforcing a culture of emulation over substance.

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Founding Figures Series:
Georg Simmel

Born: 1 March 1858, Berlin, Germany

Died: 26 September 1918, France

Key Influences

- Immanuel Kant,
- Ferdinand Tönnies,
- Karl Marx

Overview

- Pioneering German sociologist and philosopher
- Work laid important foundations in the field of sociology
- Primary focus on social forms, interactions, and the complexities of social life

Major Theories

Social Forms & Sociation

Forms of interactions (exchanges, conflicts, cooperation)

Dyad (two-person group) and Triad (three-person group) dynamics

The Metropolis and Mental Life

Rapid pace and sensory overload of city life

Developing a 'blasé attitude' as a defense mechanism

Tragedy of Culture

Culture Dichotomy: Objective culture (external elements like art, science, institutions) vs. Subjective culture (individual capacity to internalize)

Tension between external products and individual advancement

The Stranger (Social Types)

Various social types: 'The Stranger' – both near and far, part of the group yet distant due to differences

Social Distance

Social distance affects interactions and relationships; proper distance enhances objectivity

Fashion and Society:

Fashion as a form of social expression (group identity and individual differentiation)

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Founding Figures Series

Harriet Martineau

Born: 1802, England

Died: 1876, Ambleside

Key Influences

- Auguste Comte
- Utilitarianism
- Thomas Malthus
- American Society

Overview

- Considered the (Mother of Sociology)
- One of the earliest female sociologists
- Proponent of systematic methods and participant observation

Major Theories

Foundational Work in Empirical Sociology

Translated & condensed Auguste Comte's *Cours de Philosophie Positive*
Made positivist sociology accessible to English
Developed methods in (*How to Observe Morals and Manners*)

Early Feminist Sociology

Considered the first female sociologist
Analyzed the status of women using sociological tools
Examined gendered norms, patriarchy, and domestic life as oppression

Theory of Progress and Social Reform

Linked social progress to the position of the most marginalized
Argued progress is moral, reflected in equality, freedom, and
Advocated for reason and social justice

Analysis of Morals and Social Institutions

Critically assessed issues like slavery, gender inequality, and religious hypocrisy.

Society in America

Distinguished between declared morals (values) and actual practices (manners).

Religion and Secular Morality

Analyzed religion not in theological terms but as a social institution
Legitimates power and shapes moral codes.

Societal Classification & Key Concepts

Societal Classification

Critically assessed issues like slavery, gender inequality, and religious.

Religion and Secular Morality

Analyzed religion not in theological terms but as a social institution
Legitimates power and shapes moral codes.

Society in America

Major Works: (Society in America), (How to Observe Morals and Manners), (Illustrations of Political Economy)

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THE FOUNDATION TO INDIAN SOCIOLOGY

SOCIOLOGICAL DEVELOPMENTS DURING BRITISH RULE

Herbert Risley

- **British Colonial Period (18th - 19th Century):** British administrators-scholars utilized sociology for administrative purposes, focusing on tribal studies, caste census, and village surveys.
- **Figures of the British Era:** Scholass like Sir Herbert Risley (Caste Studies and Ethnography) and L.S.S. O Malley (District Gazetteers) played a crocial role.
- **Role of Census & Ethnography:** Systematic collection of data on Indian social structure was a major contribution.

THE FOUNDATION: PIONEERS OF INDIAN SOCIOLOGY

Indological Approach (Ghurye)	Field View Approach (Srinivas)
Focus: Text-based (Indology) study of Indian culture. Specific focus on Caste and Tribe structures. Key Figure: G.S. Ghurye (Father of Indian Sociology)	Focus: Empirically-driven (Field View) research. Development of key concepts: Sanskrifization, Dominant Caste. Key Figure: M.N. Srinivas

THEORETICAL PERSPECTIVES IN INDIAN SOCIOLOGY

- **Indology & Textual View:** Study from sacred texts and ancient scriptures. (Thinkers: G.S. Ghurye, Louis Dumont)
- **Structural-Functionalism in India:** Adapting Parsons and Durkheim to the Indian context. (Thinkers: M.N. Srinivas, S.C. Dube)
- **Marxist & Conflict Perspectives in India:** Analyzing class and exploitation in Indian society. (Thinkers: A.R. Desai, D.D. Kosambi)
- **Weberian Interpretative Understanding:** Looking at social action through the actor's perspective. (Thinkers: Max Weber, André Béteille)
- **Structuralism in India:** Deconstructing social categories like Caste. (Thinkers: Louis Dumont, Dipankar Gupta)
- **Critical Theory in India:** Examining power and ideology in post-colonial India. (Thinkers: Ramachandra Guha, Satish Deshpande)

Sociology as a discipline started at University of Bombay in 1919 under Patrick Geddes.
MN Srinivas is the father of Indian Sociology.

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